

## PIT at CLE · Thursday 2026-10-01 20:15 ET · Week 4 2026

League-wide only. Window: weeks 4–9, 2015–2025.  $n \geq 10$ . No team streaks. No half-EPA. Lines from nflverse games.csv (snapshot Oct 1). Scores and team-week stats through Week 3; EPA from play-by-play.

**Line:** PIT -2.5 / CLE +2.5, total 38.5. Trip: PIT → CLE 106 mi, 0 time zones. Rest: PIT 4 days, CLE 4 days. Roof: outdoors.

### 1. Season boxes

| Wk | Team | Spot     | Score | Line | ATS   | Off yds | Rush | Pass EPA | Off EPA | Def EPA allowed | SR   | TO |
|----|------|----------|-------|------|-------|---------|------|----------|---------|-----------------|------|----|
| 1  | PIT  | H vs ATL | 20–13 | -6.5 | cover | 279     | 58   | -9.7     | -16.3   | -21.5           | 0.34 | 1  |
| 2  | PIT  | A at NE  | 3–20  | +4.5 | miss  | 278     | 91   | -21.8    | -22.2   | -1.9            | 0.39 | 2  |
| 3  | PIT  | H vs CIN | 30–27 | +3.5 | cover | 430     | 138  | +8.5     | +11.3   | +14.8           | 0.49 | 1  |
| 1  | CLE  | A at JAX | 10–34 | +8.5 | miss  | 292     | 87   | -5.6     | -10.5   | +16.7           | 0.43 | 2  |
| 2  | CLE  | A at TB  | 23–19 | +8.5 | cover | 282     | 44   | +10.4    | +1.0    | -13.0           | 0.45 | 0  |
| 3  | CLE  | H vs CAR | 21–18 | +2.5 | cover | 276     | 132  | +2.1     | +0.2    | -7.7            | 0.38 | 1  |

Last game EPA (PBP): PIT off +11.3, def allowed +14.8, net -3.6, SR 0.49. CLE off +0.2, def allowed -7.7, net +7.9, SR 0.38. Records: PIT 2–1, CLE 2–1. ATS: PIT 2–1, CLE 2–1.

### 2. Lookahead and rest

- PIT: last played week 3 (Sunday early window, home, won by 3). 4 days rest. Week 5: home vs IND, non-division, Sunday early window.
- CLE: last played week 3 (Sunday early window, home, won by 3). 4 days rest. Week 5: road vs NYJ, non-division, Sunday early window.

### 3. Sides — CLE +2.5

#### CLE (home dog)

Spot anchors (nested — the same games appear in more than one row; identical populations are collapsed below):

| Cut                              | ATS       | Pct   | n   |
|----------------------------------|-----------|-------|-----|
| home dog                         | 168–169–8 | 49.9% | 345 |
| Thursday night home dog          | 13–15–1   | 46.4% | 29  |
| division home dog                | 56–53–2   | 51.4% | 111 |
| home dog +1 to +3                | 75–90–7   | 45.5% | 172 |
| division home dog +1 to +3       | 26–32–1   | 44.8% | 59  |
| Thursday night division home dog | 8–9–1     | 47.1% | 18  |
| Thursday night dog +1 to +3      | 12–15–1   | 44.4% | 28  |

Conditionals on those anchors, ranked by distance from 50% scaled by n:

| Cut                                                       | ATS      | Pct   | n   |
|-----------------------------------------------------------|----------|-------|-----|
| scored $\leq 21$ last, Thursday night                     | 36–20–1  | 64.3% | 57  |
| TO $\leq 1$ last, division home dog +1 to +3              | 11–23–1  | 32.4% | 35  |
| off an upset win as dog, Thursday night                   | 4–11–1   | 26.7% | 16  |
| off yards $\leq 300$ last, division home dog +1 to +3     | 5–12–1   | 29.4% | 18  |
| opponent off a cover, Thursday night                      | 30–19–1  | 61.2% | 50  |
| off a cover, Thursday night                               | 19–30–1  | 38.8% | 50  |
| TO $\leq 1$ last, Thursday night division home dog        | 3–8–1    | 27.3% | 12  |
| off an upset win as dog, division home dog +1 to +3       | 8–3–1    | 72.7% | 12  |
| off a home game, home dog +1 to +3                        | 18–28–1  | 39.1% | 47  |
| TO $\leq 1$ last, home dog +1 to +3                       | 41–55–2  | 42.7% | 98  |
| scored $\leq 21$ last, Thursday night home dog            | 12–6–1   | 66.7% | 19  |
| equal rest, division home dog                             | 38–27–2  | 58.5% | 67  |
| success rate $\leq .40$ last, Thursday night dog +1 to +3 | 3–7      | 30.0% | 10  |
| both off a win, division home dog                         | 11–6     | 64.7% | 17  |
| scored $\leq 21$ last, home dog                           | 109–92–7 | 54.2% | 208 |

| Cut                                          | ATS     | Pct   | n   |
|----------------------------------------------|---------|-------|-----|
| TO ≤1 last, Thursday night                   | 33–43–2 | 43.4% | 78  |
| off a win, Thursday night                    | 22–30–1 | 42.3% | 53  |
| opponent off a win, Thursday night           | 30–22–1 | 57.7% | 53  |
| scored ≤21 last, division home dog           | 40–31–2 | 56.3% | 73  |
| off yards ≤300 last, home dog +1 to +3       | 19–26–3 | 42.2% | 48  |
| def EPA allowed ≤ –5 last, division home dog | 14–9–1  | 60.9% | 24  |
| allowed ≤21 last, home dog                   | 65–54–5 | 54.6% | 124 |
| off a win, Thursday night home dog           | 3–6–1   | 33.3% | 10  |
| TO ≤1 last, Thursday night home dog          | 7–11–1  | 38.9% | 19  |
| allowed ≤21 last, division home dog          | 24–18–2 | 57.1% | 44  |
| outdoors, home dog +1 to +3                  | 54–64–7 | 45.8% | 125 |
| opponent off a win, Thursday night home dog  | 7–4     | 63.6% | 11  |
| off a cover, Thursday night dog +1 to +3     | 4–7–1   | 36.4% | 12  |

#### 4. Sides — PIT –2.5

Mirror of the chair above. Same games, other side.

##### PIT (road favorite)

Spot anchors (nested — the same games appear in more than one row; identical populations are collapsed below):

| Cut                                   | ATS       | Pct   | n   |
|---------------------------------------|-----------|-------|-----|
| road favorite                         | 169–168–8 | 50.1% | 345 |
| Thursday night road favorite          | 15–13–1   | 53.6% | 29  |
| division road favorite                | 53–56–2   | 48.6% | 111 |
| road fav –1 to –3                     | 90–75–7   | 54.5% | 172 |
| division road fav –1 to –3            | 32–26–1   | 55.2% | 59  |
| Thursday night division road favorite | 9–8–1     | 52.9% | 18  |
| Thursday night fav –1 to –3           | 15–12–1   | 55.6% | 28  |

Conditionals on those anchors, ranked by distance from 50% scaled by n:

| Cut                                                    | ATS     | Pct   | n   |
|--------------------------------------------------------|---------|-------|-----|
| def EPA allowed ≥ +10 last, road favorite              | 51–30–1 | 63.0% | 82  |
| def EPA allowed ≥ +10 last, road fav –1 to –3          | 29–14–1 | 67.4% | 44  |
| next game is home non-division, road fav –1 to –3      | 54–33–5 | 62.1% | 92  |
| off yards ≥400 last, Thursday night                    | 12–24   | 33.3% | 36  |
| off an upset win as dog, Thursday night                | 4–11–1  | 26.7% | 16  |
| next game is home, road fav –1 to –3                   | 66–48–6 | 57.9% | 120 |
| opponent off a cover, Thursday night                   | 30–19–1 | 61.2% | 50  |
| off a cover, Thursday night                            | 19–30–1 | 38.8% | 50  |
| allowed ≥27 last, road fav –1 to –3                    | 33–22–3 | 60.0% | 58  |
| allowed ≥27 last, road favorite                        | 61–46–3 | 57.0% | 110 |
| off a home game, Thursday night fav –1 to –3           | 12–6–1  | 66.7% | 19  |
| off yards ≥400 last, road fav –1 to –3                 | 37–26–2 | 58.7% | 65  |
| equal rest, division road favorite                     | 27–38–2 | 41.5% | 67  |
| allowed ≥27 last, division road fav –1 to –3           | 13–7–1  | 65.0% | 21  |
| 0 time zones, road fav –1 to –3                        | 37–27–3 | 57.8% | 67  |
| next game is home non-division, road favorite          | 95–79–5 | 54.6% | 179 |
| both off a win, division road favorite                 | 6–11    | 35.3% | 17  |
| def EPA allowed ≥ +10 last, division road fav –1 to –3 | 8–4     | 66.7% | 12  |
| TO ≤1 last, Thursday night                             | 33–43–2 | 43.4% | 78  |

| Cut                                                        | ATS     | Pct   | n   |
|------------------------------------------------------------|---------|-------|-----|
| scored 27–33 last, Thursday night                          | 11–17   | 39.3% | 28  |
| off a win, Thursday night                                  | 22–30–1 | 42.3% | 53  |
| opponent off a win, Thursday night                         | 30–22–1 | 57.7% | 53  |
| off a home game, division road fav –1 to –3                | 24–17–1 | 58.5% | 42  |
| off a home game, road fav –1 to –3                         | 61–50–4 | 55.0% | 115 |
| 0 time zones, division road fav –1 to –3                   | 20–14–1 | 58.8% | 35  |
| next game is home non-division, division road fav –1 to –3 | 21–15   | 58.3% | 36  |
| opponent off a win, Thursday night road favorite           | 6–3–1   | 66.7% | 10  |
| next game is home non-division, division road favorite     | 38–30   | 55.9% | 68  |

## 5. Total 38.5

| Cut                                           | Over–Under | Over pct | n   |
|-----------------------------------------------|------------|----------|-----|
| division game, home dog, total $\leq 40$      | 2–12       | 14.3%    | 14  |
| division game, total $\leq 39$                | 2–9        | 18.2%    | 11  |
| division game, total $\leq 42$                | 21–36      | 36.8%    | 57  |
| division game, total $\leq 40$                | 6–15       | 28.6%    | 21  |
| division game, outdoors, total $\leq 39$      | 2–8        | 20.0%    | 10  |
| home dog, line within 3, total $\leq 39$      | 4–11       | 26.7%    | 15  |
| line within 3, visitor <200 mi                | 4–10–1     | 28.6%    | 15  |
| line within 3, total $\leq 39$                | 9–17       | 34.6%    | 26  |
| division game, outdoors, total $\leq 40$      | 5–11       | 31.2%    | 16  |
| division game, line within 3, total $\leq 40$ | 4–9        | 30.8%    | 13  |
| line within 3, short week for a team          | 17–10–1    | 63.0%    | 28  |
| outdoors, home dog, total $\leq 39$           | 7–13–1     | 35.0%    | 21  |
| outdoors, line within 3, total $\leq 39$      | 8–14       | 36.4%    | 22  |
| outdoors, total $\leq 39$                     | 17–25–1    | 40.5%    | 43  |
| home dog, total $\leq 39$                     | 9–15–1     | 37.5%    | 25  |
| division game, line within 3                  | 54–65–3    | 45.4%    | 122 |
| total $\leq 39$                               | 21–28–1    | 42.9%    | 50  |
| outdoors, home dog                            | 122–138–2  | 46.9%    | 262 |
| line within 3, total $\leq 42$                | 44–53      | 45.4%    | 97  |
| short week for a team                         | 36–29–1    | 55.4%    | 66  |
| outdoors, total $\leq 42$                     | 86–75–1    | 53.4%    | 162 |
| division game, home dog                       | 50–59–2    | 45.9%    | 111 |

## 6. What does not apply

- 2+ time-zone trip: no
- double-digit dog: no
- off a 10-point loss: no
- off a 20-point win: no
- 2nd straight home game: applies to CLE
- 2nd straight road game: no
- bye next week: no
- off a bye: no
- scored  $\leq 10$  last: no
- short week: applies to CLE, PIT
- trip  $\geq 1000$  mi: no
- TO  $\geq 3$  last: no
- undefeated entering: no

- winless entering: no

## 7. Stack, without double-counting

Stack floor is  $n \geq 20$  (tables use  $n \geq 10$ ) so the conjunction cannot bottom out on the cutoff.

- **CLE +2.5** — one population: Thursday night dog +1 to +3; outdoors. ATS 9–10–1 (47.4%,  $n=20$ ). Not added ( $n$  would fall under 20, or the trait does not narrow the population): off a win, off a 1-score win, off a cover, off an upset win as dog, off a home game, 2nd straight home game, host of a short-trip visitor (<200 mi), next game is road....
- **PIT -2.5** — one population: Thursday night fav -1 to -3; outdoors. ATS 10–9–1 (52.6%,  $n=20$ ). Not added ( $n$  would fall under 20, or the trait does not narrow the population): off a win, off a 1-score win, off a cover, off an upset win as dog, off a home game, off a division game, short trip <200 mi, 0 time zones....

Feeds: nflverse games.csv (lines, scores, rest), stats\_team\_week 2015–2026 (yards, pass EPA, TO), play\_by\_play 2015–2026 (off/def EPA, success rate), data/airports.csv (miles, zones).